

Plastic in Our Oceans: answers

Year 6 · 13 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Microplastics. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). Finding a key term in the first section, which the rest of the text builds on.

2. It is an approximate figure, a careful judgement rather than an exact count. (2 marks)

Word meaning (2a). Understanding how a single word shapes how much to trust a fact.

3. Any two of: cheap, light, strong (1 mark for two). (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). Finding a short list in the first sentence.

4. The things that make plastic useful (cheap, light, strong) also make it a problem, because it lasts for so long and is thrown away in huge amounts. (2 marks)

Language choices. Seeing the writer's point that one fact can have two sides.

5. They swallow it by mistake, thinking it is food, and it can make them ill. (2 marks)

Inference (2d). Joining the cause (looks like food) to the effect (harm) across two sentences.

6. One mark for the actions people and engineers can take (reusable items, recycling, nets and barriers); one mark for the argument that governments and companies must make less plastic.

(2 marks)

Summarising (2c). Reducing a paragraph to its main ideas.

7. Governments and companies, because the writer says experts argue individual efforts “will not be enough unless” they also make less plastic. (Accept a reasoned answer that says both are needed, if it uses that sentence.) (2 marks)

Giving a view with evidence. Working out what the writer thinks from how the arguments are ordered and weighted.

8. C (1 mark)

Summarising (2c). Choosing a best summary means testing each option against the whole text.